

Meet India's U-19 Women's World Cup-winning side

Lavanya Lakshmi Narayanan

lavanya.l@thehindu.co.in

India reigns supreme in the Under-19 ecosystem with two world titles in two editions. After Shafali Verma's squad lifted the inaugural title, Niki Prasad's team also went unbeaten to claim the second championship in Kuala Lumpur.

Niki Prasad (C)

After missing out on the 2023 World Cup squad, Niki turned disappointment into drive. Selected for the U-16 State team at nine, she led her team to the U-19 Women's T20 Trophy in 2022 and later captained India to U-19 Asia Cup and World Cup glory.

Though she had little to do with the bat, her tactical acumen — effective bowling rotations and attacking field settings — was crucial. She will play for Delhi Capitals in WPL 2025.

Sanika Chalke (VC)

From Mumbai's gullies to the World Cup final, Sanika's journey has been remarkable. Her solid one-down presence ensured stability, scoring 95 runs in seven matches at an average of 95.00.

V.J. Joshitha

Hailing from Wayanad, Joshitha's prodigious swing rattled batters, especially in overcast Kuala Lumpur. Her twin strikes against West Indies set the tone for India's dominance. While spinners thrived, her outswingers remained unplayable. With six wickets from six matches, she heads to Royal Challengers Bengaluru in WPL 2025.

G. Kamalini (wk)

Sixteen-year-old Kamalini, a left-hander from Madurai, scored 143 runs, including two fifties. A stellar wicketkeeper, she took six dismissals, including a

brehtaking one-handed diving catch in the final. She will play for Mumbai Indians, who signed her for Rs 1.6 crore.

Shabnam Shakil

A two-time U-19 World Cup winner, Shabnam has honed her accuracy and pace.

Though she took only four wickets, her economy rate suffocated batters. Gujarat Giants' coach Michael Klinger has identified her as a future star, making her a player to watch.

Vaishnavi Sharma

India's spin attack was led by Vaishnavi, who finished as the tournament's highest wicket-taker (17). She claimed a record-breaking hat-trick in the opener against Malaysia and continued to strike consistently in the middle overs.

Aayushi Shukla

India's second-leading wicket-taker, Aayushi, built on her Asia Cup form, scalping 14 wickets in seven matches, including a four-fer against Scotland. A capable batter, she once struck a century in domestic cricket.

Parunika Sisodia

Parunika, 19, completed India's formidable left-arm spin trio, claiming 10 wickets. Her 2/6 in the